

Word family: **cool / cooler / coolest / coolly / coolness**

Base word: cool

Comparative: cooler

Superlative: coolest

Related forms: coolly, coolness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞) / noun-related use (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “...how to keep a **cool head**, how to respect the process, and how to build my life on solid ground rather than on sand.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **cool** appears in the fixed expression **keep a cool head**.

It means to **stay calm, think clearly, and avoid panicking or reacting emotionally in a difficult situation**.

繁體中文：***在壓力、混亂或困難情況下保持冷靜和清晰判斷，不慌亂、不衝動**

中文翻譯：

> “...how to keep a **cool head**...”

「.....如何在壓力下**保持冷靜、頭腦清醒**.....」

Here:

keep a cool head = 保持冷靜和理性判斷

1. **cool = slightly cold / pleasantly low in temperature (溫度) — 涼的 ; 清涼的**

This is the central literal meaning.

Meaning: Fairly cold, but usually not extremely cold.

Practice 1

> “The evening air was **cool**.”

「晚上的空氣很**涼爽**。」

Practice 2

> “Keep the medicine in a **cool** place.”

「把藥物存放在**陰涼 / 較涼爽**的地方。」

cool = 溫度較低、帶涼意，但通常不表示非常寒冷

Common:

- * cool air
- * cool weather
- * cool water
- * cool room

2. **cool** = calm / emotionally controlled (情緒) — 冷靜的；沉著的

This is the meaning behind your sentence.

Meaning: Calm and able to control your emotions, especially under pressure.

Practice 3 — Original family use

> “He taught me how to keep a **cool head**.”

「他教會我如何**保持冷靜和理智**。」

Practice 4

> “She stayed **cool** during the emergency.”

「她在緊急情況下仍然保持**冷靜**。」

Practice 5

> “Try to remain **cool** and think clearly.”

「盡量保持**冷靜**，清楚思考。」

cool = 面對壓力、衝突或危機時仍然冷靜、不慌亂的

This is a major figurative sense.

3. **cool = unfriendly / emotionally distant (人際) — 冷淡的 ; 疏遠的**

Cool can describe a person, attitude, or relationship that lacks warmth or friendliness.

Practice 6

> “Her response was polite but **cool**.”

「她的回應很有禮貌，但有點**冷淡**。」

Practice 7

> “Relations between them became **cool** after the disagreement.”

「爭執後，他們之間的關係變得**疏遠 / 冷淡**。」

cool = 態度或關係缺乏熱情、親近感或友善

This is distinct from calmness:

* calm → emotionally controlled

* cool → can also mean emotionally distant

4. **cool = fashionable / impressive / socially attractive (非正式) — 有型的 ; 很棒的 ; 很酷的**

In informal English, **cool** can mean fashionable, impressive, admirable, or attractive.

Practice 8

> “That jacket looks really **cool**.”

「那件外套看起來很**有型 / 很酷**。」

Practice 9

> “That’s a **cool** idea.”

「那是個很**棒 / 很酷**的想法。」

cool = 非正式地表示某人 / 某物有型、令人欣賞、吸引或很不錯

This is one of the most common modern colloquial meanings.

5. **cool = acceptable / okay (口語) — 可以的 ; 沒問題的**

In informal speech, **cool** can mean acceptable or agreed.

Practice 10

> “Is six o’clock okay?”

> “Yeah, that’s **cool**.”

「六點可以嗎？」

「可以，**沒問題**。」

Practice 11

> “I’m **cool** with that.”

「我對那件事**沒問題 / 可以接受**。」

cool = 非正式地表示同意、接受或覺得沒有問題

For strict counting, I would keep this as a colloquial extension of the positive/social sense rather than a fully separate major core meaning.

6. **cool = become less hot (動詞) — 變涼 ; 冷卻**

As a verb, **cool** means to become less hot.

Practice 12

> “Let the soup **cool** before you eat it.”

「先讓湯**放涼**再喝。」

Practice 13

> “The metal **cooled** quickly.”

「金屬很快**冷卻**了。」

cool = 溫度降低，變得比較涼

7. **cool = make something less hot (使冷卻) — 使變涼 ; 冷卻**

The verb can also be transitive.

Practice 14

> “The fan helped **cool** the room.”

「風扇幫助房間**降溫**。」

Practice 15

> “Water is used to **cool** the engine.”

「水被用來**冷卻**引擎。」

cool something = 使某物溫度下降

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 6.

8. **cool = become less intense (情緒 / 局勢) — 緩和 ; 冷卻**

The temperature metaphor extends to emotions, conflict, enthusiasm, etc.

Practice 16

> “Their anger gradually **cooled**.”

「他們的怒氣逐漸**平息**。」

Practice 17

> “Interest in the product has **cooled**.”

「大家對那件產品的興趣已經**減退 / 冷卻**。」

cool = 情緒、熱情、衝突或興趣的強度逐漸降低

This is a major figurative verb extension from literal temperature.

9. **cool = large amount of money, informal (非正式) — 整整.....金額**

In informal English, especially in phrases like ****a cool million****, ****cool**** can emphasize a surprisingly large amount.

Practice 18

> “The house sold for a ****cool**** two million dollars.”

「那間屋以****整整 / 高達****二百萬美元售出。」

Practice 19

> “He earned a ****cool**** hundred thousand from the deal.”

「他從那宗交易賺了****足足****十萬元。」

****a cool + amount = 非正式地強調金額很大、令人印象深刻****

This is a lower-priority but established modern use.

Related form: ****coolly****

****Coolly**** has two useful branches.

****coolly = calmly (冷靜地)****

Practice 20

> “She ****coolly**** explained what had happened.”

「她****冷靜地****解釋事情經過。」

****coolly = without warmth (冷淡地)****

Practice 21

> “He greeted me ****coolly****.”

「他****冷淡地****向我打招呼。」

So ****coolly**** can mean either:

* with calm control

* with emotional distance

Context matters.

Related form: **coolness**

Coolness can mean:

- * low temperature
- * calmness
- * emotional distance

Practice 22

> “The **coolness** of the evening was refreshing.”

「晚上的**涼意**很舒服。」

Practice 23

> “Her **coolness** under pressure impressed everyone.”

「她在壓力下的**冷靜**令所有人印象深刻。」

Practice 24

> “There was a noticeable **coolness** between them.”

「他們之間明顯有一種**冷淡 / 疏離感**。」

This is a good example of one family form carrying several branches of the base adjective.

Important distinction: **cool vs cold**

cool

usually means moderately low in temperature.

cold

means lower in temperature and stronger.

> cool water = 涼水

> cold water = 冷水

Figuratively:

> cool person

may mean calm or fashionable.

> cold person

usually means emotionally unfriendly or lacking warmth.

So they overlap only partly.

Important distinction: **cool vs calm**

This is especially relevant to your sentence.

calm

directly means not agitated, anxious, or excited.

cool

can mean calm, but often adds:

- * emotional control
- * composure
- * ability to think clearly

So:

> keep calm

= 保持冷靜

> keep a cool head

= 保持冷靜，而且頭腦清醒、判斷理性

Important distinction: **cool vs chilled**

cool

= mildly cold

chilled

often means deliberately cooled in a fridge or cooler.

> cool water

> chilled juice

Different degree and context.

Important distinction: **cool vs hip**

You already mapped **hip**.

cool

can mean generally impressive, attractive, or socially appealing.

hip

more specifically suggests being current with fashion, culture, or trends.

> cool idea

very broad.

> hip café

more trend/culture-oriented.

Important distinction: **cool vs aloof**

cool

can simply mean somewhat emotionally distant.

aloof

is stronger and means deliberately distant, detached, or not friendly.

So:

> a cool response

may be mildly distant.

> an aloof person

suggests a more enduring personality/attitude.

Target expression: ****keep a cool head — 保持冷靜、頭腦清醒****

Practice 25 — Original

> “He taught me how to ****keep a cool head****.”

「他教會我如何****保持冷靜和頭腦清醒****。」

Practice 26

> “You need to ****keep a cool head**** in an emergency.”

「遇到緊急情況時，你需要****保持冷靜和理性****。」

****keep a cool head = 在壓力、危機或混亂中保持冷靜和清晰判斷****

This belongs to Meaning 2.

Useful expression: ****lose your cool — 失去冷靜；發脾氣****

Practice 27

> “He nearly ****lost his cool**** during the argument.”

「他在爭論中差點****失去冷靜 / 發脾氣****。」

Practice 28

> “Try not to ****lose your cool****.”

「盡量不要****失去冷靜****。」

Here **cool** functions as a noun meaning calmness/composure.

This is a fixed informal expression rather than another core meaning.

Useful expression: **play it cool** — 裝作冷靜；不露聲色

Practice 29

> “She was excited but tried to **play it cool**.”

「她其實很興奮，但嘗試**裝作若無其事 / 保持冷靜**。」

play it cool = 刻意表現得冷靜、不太熱情或不露出真正情緒

This is an idiom rather than a new core sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **cool**

* **cooler**

* **coolest**

* **coolly**

* **coolness**

Useful constructions include:

* cool weather

* stay cool

* cool response

* cool idea

* cool down

* keep a cool head

* lose your cool

* play it cool

* a cool million

The Golden Manual says common figurative meanings and fixed expressions should be checked, while closely related temperature metaphors should still be grouped when one semantic idea explains them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cool — temperature	溫度較低、帶涼意但通常不是很冷的
cool — calm/composed	面對壓力或困難時仍然冷靜、沉着並能清楚思考的
cool — emotionally distant	態度或關係缺乏熱情、親近感或友善的；冷淡的
cool — fashionable/impressive	非正式地表示有型、吸引、令人欣賞或很不錯的
cool — acceptable	非正式地表示可以、沒問題、可接受；與 positive-social 義相關
cool — verb, temperature	變涼或使某物冷卻
cool — verb, intensity	情緒、衝突、興趣或熱情的強度降低
cool + amount	非正式地強調一筆相當大的金額
coolly	冷靜地；亦可指冷淡地
coolness	涼意、冷靜或冷淡狀態，依語境而定

For your original sentence

> “...how to keep a **cool head**...”

The exact meaning is:

****cool = 冷靜、沉着，不被情緒或壓力控制****

The whole expression means:

> ****keep a cool head = 在困難或壓力下仍保持理性、冷靜和清晰判斷****

So the grandfather's lesson is not about physical temperature at all. It is about emotional self-control.

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****cool****:

1. ****slightly cold / pleasantly low in temperature****
2. ****calm and emotionally controlled****
3. ****emotionally distant or unfriendly****
4. ****informal — fashionable, impressive, or attractive****
5. ****verb — become/make less hot****
6. ****verb — become less intense emotionally or situationally****

I would keep ****cool = acceptable**** as a colloquial extension of #4, keep ****a cool million**** as a lower-priority informal use, and treat ****keep a cool head, lose your cool, play it cool**** as fixed expressions rather than inflate the core count.